# How trading on abdmall works

Buyers and sellers, with abdmall in the middle · October 2026

> abdmall is a place where people buy and sell from each other — **peer to peer, with abdmall as the moderator**. abdmall holds the money, the goods pass through its warehouse, and the buyer sees the item before anyone is paid. Neither side has to trust the other; they only have to trust abdmall.

## 1 A sale, step by step

1. **A seller lists an item**
   Sellers are met and vetted by abdmall before they can list anything.
2. **A buyer pays into abdmall**
   The money is held by abdmall. The seller has not been paid. The item is reserved so nobody else can buy it.
3. **abdmall tells the seller to bring the goods in**
   This is the point of taking payment first: the seller knows the buyer is serious before making the trip.
4. **The buyer comes to the warehouse and inspects the item**
   In person, with their own eyes, before committing.
5. **If the buyer is happy, they sign for it and take it**
   abdmall then pays the seller, keeping its commission.
6. **If the buyer is not happy, nobody is paid**
   The item goes back to the seller and the buyer is refunded.

> **WHY THIS IS BETTER THAN THE USUAL ARRANGEMENT**
>
> The buyer never sends money to a stranger. The seller never hands over goods to one. And because the buyer inspects the item themselves, **abdmall never has to judge whether a product is good enough** — the person who is paying for it decides that.

## 2 The rules that make it work

Two deadlines and two ways a sale can fall through. Every case has an answer, so nothing sits unresolved:

| SITUATION | WHAT HAPPENS |
|---|---|
| **Seller has 48 hours to deliver to the warehouse** | If they miss it, the buyer is refunded automatically and the seller gets a strike. |
| **Buyer has 5 days to come and inspect** | If they do not come, the item goes back to the seller and the buyer gets a strike. |
| **Buyer rejects because the item is not as described** | Full refund. The seller gets a strike — they listed it wrongly. |
| **Buyer rejects because they changed their mind** | Full refund, but the buyer gets a strike — the seller made that trip for nothing. |

Repeat strikes mean losing access to abdmall. This matters most to sellers: they are the ones who spend time and transport on every sale, and they will stop using abdmall if buyers waste their trips without consequence.

SOMETHING TO WATCH

We suggest **not deducting any money** from a buyer's refund at first, even when the wasted trip is their fault — taking money off a refund causes more arguments than it is worth. Strikes alone should be enough while volumes are small. If wasted trips become common, a small fee paid to the seller can be added later. It is much easier to introduce one than to remove one.

## 3 The numbers

| ITEM | VALUE |
|---|---|
| **abdmall's commission** | **10% of the sale price**, taken from the seller when the sale completes |
| **Seller delivery window** | 48 hours from the buyer paying |
| **Buyer collection window** | 5 days from the goods arriving |
| **Collection points** | One warehouse to begin with |

The seller only pays when they are paid, which makes abdmall easy to join. Nothing is charged for a sale that falls through.

## 4 What this means for abdmall

- **A room and someone to run it.** Goods only arrive after a buyer has paid, and leave within days, so this is a holding room rather than a warehouse full of stock.
- **Meeting every seller.** This is the strongest protection in the whole design. Because you have met them, a strike means something and a seller taking money and disappearing is far less likely.
- **The money being held is not abdmall's.** It belongs to the buyer until they accept the goods, and to the seller after that. It needs its own bank account that is never spent from.
- **One judgement to make.** When a buyer rejects an item, someone decides whether it was genuinely not as described, or the buyer simply changed their mind. That is the only call abdmall has to make, and it is made with the item and the listing photographs both in front of you.

TWO THINGS TO SETTLE EARLY

**Holding other people's money is regulated in Nigeria.** Many platforms operate this way, but it is worth a short conversation with your bank or a lawyer before volumes grow.

**One warehouse means one city.** The website must make the collection location clear before anyone pays, or you will spend your time refunding buyers who did not realise they had to travel.

## 5 What we need from you

- The **warehouse address**, and the hours buyers can come to inspect.
- How you want to **vet sellers** — what you check, and who does it.
- Confirmation of the four numbers in section 3.

Once we have those, we can build it.